

WEEK 12

SIMPLE PAST TO BE

Read the following text and check the bold words.

Phil: Hi, Maria. You look a little tired. What did you do last night? **Were you** out?
Maria: No, I stayed home. I saw a horror movie on TV.
Phil: **Was it** good?
Maria: It **was** really scary.
Phil: **Were you** with anyone?
Maria: No, I **was** alone. That's why it **was** so scary. I **was** awake all night!
Phil: Next time, call me!
Maria: I tried, but there **was** no answer. **Were you** at home?
Phil: No, actually. I **was** at my acting class.
Maria: **Was it** interesting?
Phil: Yes, we had a guest speaker. He **was** funny.
Maria: Who **was** it?
Phil: A comedian. He talked about comedy.
Maria: That sounds fun. Next time I'll go to class with you!

The past form of verb **be**: **was and were**

Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative	Short Answer
I was tired.	I was not tired.	Was I tired?	Yes, I was.
You were happy.	You weren't sad.	Were you happy?	Yes, you were.
He was ready.	She wasn't ready.	Was it ready?	No, it wasn't.
We were friends.	We were not enemies.	Were we friends?	Yes, we were.
You were students.	We were not teachers.	Were you teachers?	No, you weren't.
They were classmates.	They weren't siblings.	Were they family?	No, they were not.

We talk about people and situations in the past with **was** and **were**.

It **was** really scary.

They **were** at home two days ago.

In negative sentences we use **was not** or **were not**. The short forms are **wasn't** and **weren't**.

I **wasn't** at home last night.

You **weren't** ready for the party yesterday.

In questions we put **was** or **were** in the beginning of the sentence before the subject.

Were you out?

Was it interesting?

Who **was** it?

Where **were** they?

The time expressions we use with **simple past** are . . . (two days). . **ago**, **yesterday**, **last** . . . (night / week)

Exercises:

I. Fill in the sentences with the correct past form of verb to *be*.

- 1) Sarah (be) _____ at the party last night, but Li-Ning and Akmoud (not be) _____ there. They (be) _____ at home
- 2) Amy (be) _____ my best friend. She and I (be) _____ in the same English class.
- 3) Malika and Fred (be) _____ at Jenny's house yesterday.
- 4) Johan (be) _____ in the mountains. He (be) _____ on a camping trip.
- 5) When she (be) _____ young, Iesha (not be) _____ interested in science.
- 6) Tennis (not be) _____ my favourite sport when I (be) _____ in high school.

II. Fill in the sentences with the correct past form of verb to *be*.

1. A: _____ you at home yesterday? B: Yes, I _____.
2. They _____ really happy after the game. It was a great game.
3. My sister _____ a college student last year. She was at high school.

4. Thomas _____ in hospital yesterday because he was ill.
5. A: _____ Jennifer tired after work? B: No, she _____.
6. My car was broken, so I _____ late for my appointment.
7. A: _____ Laura and Susan surprised? B: No, they _____.
8. The cookies _____ delicious, so I had three of them.

III. Fill in the sentences with the correct past form of be verb.

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|---|---|
| A (1) <u>Were</u> you at Charlotte's party last Saturday? | A (5) _____ there many people? |
| B Yes, I (2) <u>was</u> . | B Yes, there (6) _____. Hundreds! |
| A (3) _____ it good? | A (7) _____ Sophie there? |
| B Well, it (4) _____ OK. | B No, she (8) _____. Why (9) _____ you there? |
| | A Well, I couldn't go to Charlotte's party because I (10) _____ at Dave's party. It (11) _____ great! |

IV. Fill in the sentences with the correct past form of verb to be.

1. A: _____ you at the library yesterday? B: No, I _____.
2. Dinosaurs _____ really huge.
3. I _____ born in 1996. When _____ you born?
4. The movie we saw last night _____ very funny. We enjoyed it a lot.
5. I _____ a waiter last year, but I am a chef now.
6. My favourite program _____ on TV at eight o'clock last night.
7. My classmates _____ in class. They were in the garden.

V. Fill in the sentences with the correct present or past form of verb to be.

- 1) My family and I (to be) _____ in the pool when it began to rain. I (be) _____ upset because we couldn't swim.

2) Lenny (be) _____ at the football game last night. It (be) _____ his favorite team's match. After the game, he came back home and went to sleep. I think he (be) _____ still asleep now. Shhhh... don't wake him up!

3) It rained all day yesterday. I (be) _____ sad because I could not go outside. However, today it (be) _____ sunny. And I (be) _____ happy because I can go outside!

4) Yoko and Kobi (be) _____ enemies in the past. Now they (be) _____ best friends.